

HIGH SCHOOLS

Grizzlies storm state

No. 6 Wadsworth feels more like No. 1 now

By DICK ZUNT

PLAIN DEALER REPORTER

COLUMBUS — Wadsworth's Lady Grizzlies finished No. 6 in the final Associated Press poll but wound up first in the state.

In one of the most electrifying finishes in state tournament history, the Lady Grizzlies came up with their second shocker in two nights, winning the Division I girls' basketball state championship over Mason, 54-52, on a driving layup by 5-6 sophomore guard Kate Lyren that just beat the final buzzer.

Lyren was on the receiving end of a sizzling pass from backcourt partner Jenny Martin, who is 5-0.

The previous night, the Grizzlies edged the state's No. 1 big school team, Pickerington, 48-47. Wadsworth defeated Pickering-

ton, which was ranked No. 2 in the nation by USA Today, to stun a crowd of 10,716.

"Tonight, we were not playing our type of basketball, more their style," Wadsworth senior guard Kristin Hoover said of their win over Mason. "We got down [in the score], but deep down inside, I knew that we would fight back."

"Like [Friday] night, against Pickerington, we did not lose hope."

Wadsworth came back from a 46-39 deficit with 6:13 left in the game.

"On our last possession [with 14.1 seconds remaining], Wadsworth obviously did a good job of not letting us get close to the basket," said Mason coach Gerry Lackey, in his seventh season at the suburban Cincinnati school.

"We tried to get the ball back to

[5-7 freshman] Beth Jones, but they covered that up real well. Beth has been a real gamer for us," Lackey said of his star, who led all scorers with 21 points. "We want the ball with her with the game on the line."

"For what she has done for us and being only a freshman, she is to be commended," Lackey said. "With games on the line, good teams turn it up and both we and Wadsworth did it tonight," he said.

"When we had our last possession, we tried to go backside underneath, but it's my fault because we had no second option on the situation. It's my fault."

"We had been coming back all through the tournaments," Lackey said. "But, tonight, Wadsworth did a good job of coming back on us."

Wadsworth girls win state title

WADSWORTH FROM 1-C

Martin, the daughter of Wadsworth boys coach John Martin, immediately turned up the floor and began dribbling down the right side. Just after crossing half court, she spotted Lyren, who was leading a race toward the basket. Martin got the ball to Lyren. An instant after the ball left her hand, the horn sounded and the Wadsworth side of the arena exploded in a raucous celebration.

Wadsworth upset top-ranked Pickerington in Friday's semifinals when it scored with 26 seconds remaining.

"Oh my God," said Martin, who scored 11 of her team-high 14 points in the fourth quarter to spark a Wadsworth rally. Wadsworth trailed, 40-36, entering the fourth quarter after seeing a first-half lead disappear in the third quarter. "When I looked up I saw five seconds and I saw Kate and Katelyn [Vujas] out in front of me. All I could think of was to get the ball to Kate. She caught [it] and made the basket, and we're the state champions."

Lyren was involved in an incident with Mason's Anne Lippert with 5:41 to play and Mason leading, 46-39.

Lyren ended up on the floor with Lippert standing over her. After a stoppage in play, Lippert intentionally stepped on Lyren. No foul was called, but Wadsworth went on to outscore the Comets, 15-6, the rest of the way.

"I saw Jenny with five seconds to go," Lyren said. "She got me the ball. I never thought of pulling up for a jump shot. I didn't want to get fouled. I didn't want to go to the line. The ball went in and I started thinking that we are the state champs."

Wadsworth (26-1) had balance. In addition to Martin's 14 points, Lyren had 13, Elisa Inman had 12 and Vujas had 11. Inman had nine rebounds as Wadsworth won that war, 27-20.

Mason (25-2) was led by freshman Beth Jones, who scored 21 points and almost did Wadsworth in by herself in the third quarter when she scored 12 points.

Meyer finished with 12 points and Lippert had 10.

Unlike its semifinal victory over Pickerington on Friday, in which it trailed until the fourth quarter, Wadsworth took command midway through the second quarter to build a 27-20 halftime lead.

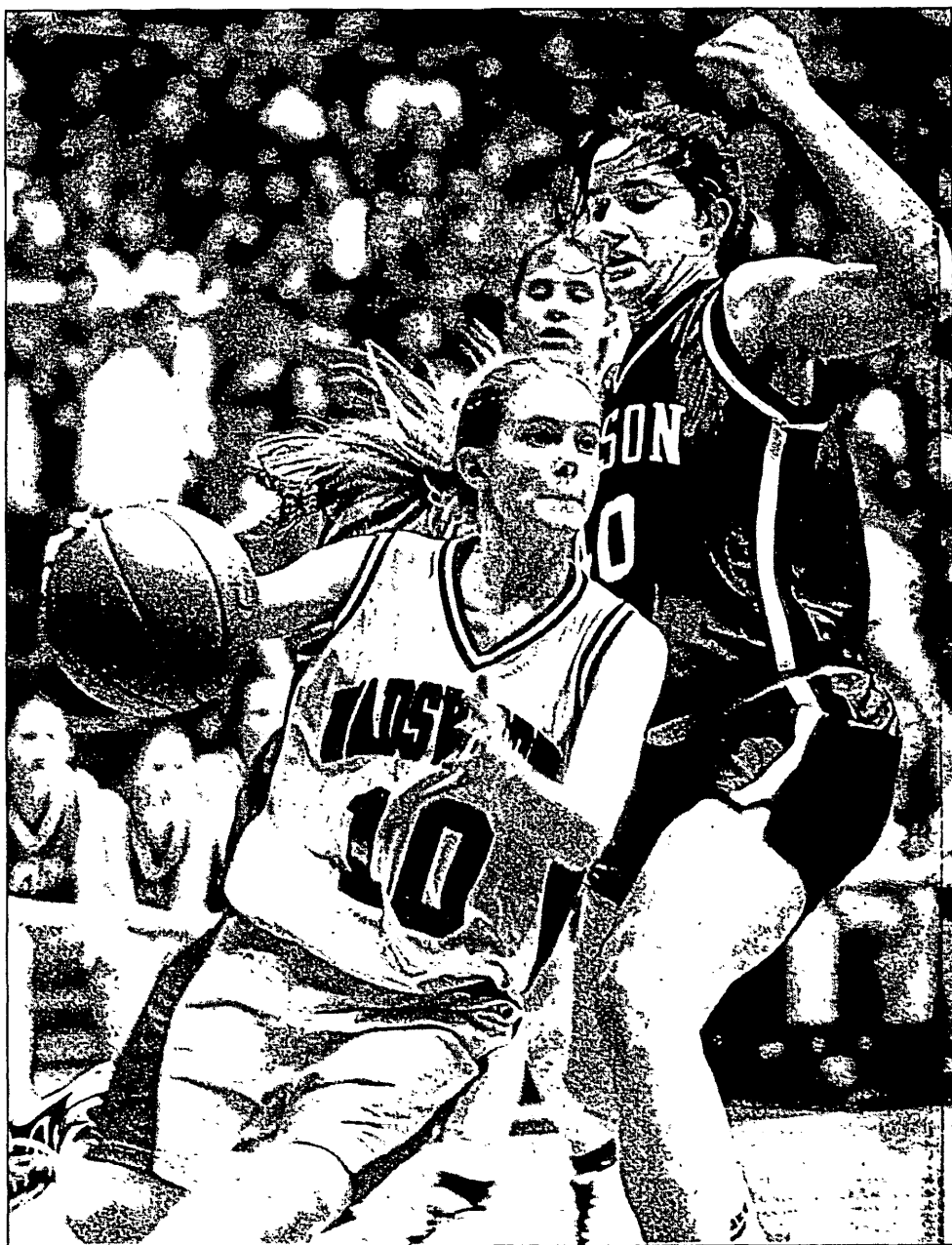
Mason led, 15-14, when the Lady Grizzlies scored nine points in a row. Lyren, who scored eight points in the quarter, got the run going when she stole the ball and scored on a 14-foot jumper from the right side. Martin ended it with a 3-pointer.

In between, the Grizzlies got baskets from substitutes Stephanie Schaffer and Jennifer Pack, both juniors. Pack missed Wadsworth's previous two games because of religious beliefs.

The lead didn't last long into the second half as Mason dominated the third quarter.

The Comets used a 10-0 run to take a 30-27 lead. Meyer scored six straight points and Jones made two free throws and scored on a short jumper.

Jones, 5-7, had consecutive 3-pointers that lifted the Comets to a 40-34 lead.



GUS CHAN / PLAIN DEALER PHOTOGRAPHER

Wadsworth's Jenny Martin, here driving past Mason's Kendra Meyer, had 14 points in the Lady Grizzlies' victory.

GIRLS STATE TOURNAMENT NOTES

Wadsworth's Pack returns

COLUMBUS — Wadsworth's Jennifer Pack was back last night.

The 5-10 junior, whose religious beliefs prevent her from participating in anything not church-related from sundown on Friday until sundown on Saturday, was in uniform last night when Wadsworth's girls played Mason for the Division I state championship in St. John Arena.

Pack missed the Lady Grizzlies' thrilling 48-47 victory over previously undefeated and top-ranked Pickerington in Friday's semifinals.

Instead, she waited alone at the team hotel in Worthington. She occasionally tuned in the radio to find out what was going on.

"I was very calm until the fourth quarter," Pack said, referring to Wadsworth's rally from an 11-point deficit. "When the game was over I think I looked a little dorky. I was jumping all over the room."

Pack, a member of the Global Church of God, met the team when it arrived back at the hotel.

"There wasn't a lot said," Pack said, "there just were a lot of hugs."

WHAT'S NEXT? — Deb Lammers, who coached Kalida to yesterday's Division IV state title with a 42-38 victory over Fort Loramie, is in her first season as head coach.

Kalida's nickname is the Ladycats. Don't you think the Scopes would be better?

TOURNEY TEAM — After pulling down 37 rebounds and scoring 30 points in two games, Chagrin's Katie Carson was named to the all-tournament team in Division III. In Division I, Wadsworth's Jenny Martin was named MVP of the all-tournament team, which also included Kate Lyren, Katelyn Vujas and Elisa Inman from Wadsworth and Beth Jones from Mason.

THE BULGE — Elida's 37-point (70-33) victory over Vincent Warren was the largest margin of victory in a Division II state championship game, but it was not the largest margin in any final four game. That honor is still held by Trinity, which defeated Bellefontaine by 42 points (77-35) in the Division II semifinals last year.



GUS CHAN / PLAIN DEALER PHOTOGRAPHER

Sisters Trish Kruse, right, and Katie Kruse of Chagrin Falls console one other after Chagrin Falls' loss to Wauseon in the Division III final yesterday.

SPORTSCHANNEL OFF — SportsChannel has televised both the girls and boys state basketball tournaments the past few years, but will not show them this year.

"Without discussing numbers, it became cost-prohibitive for SportsChannel to do it," said Ohio High School Athletic Association Commissioner Clair Muscaro. The only chance to see final four games is on local television.

ROTATE REFS — The OHSAA has adopted a "no-repeat" rule for officials working state final four games.

Officials who worked this 22nd girls bas-

ketball state tournament can't work a girls state tournament game for two years.

However, an official who worked a girls game this year can work a boys tournament game next year. An official who works a boys game this weekend can work a girls tournament game in 1998, but must wait until 1999 to work another boys game.

"There are a lot of good officials who have worked hard and have long years of service," Muscaro said. "We want to give every official the chance to become a part of the state tournament."

TIM ROGERS, DICK ZUNT

Elida defeats Vincent Warren to take Division II title

FROM WIRE REPORTS

COLUMBUS — A lingering, two-year heartache finally eased for Elida yesterday.

First-team All-Ohioan Jennifer Phillips, playing with a sprained ankle, scored 23 points and had 11 rebounds to lead Elida to a 70-33 victory over Vincent

Bacon, 64-48, in the title game.

"Just because we got this championship it doesn't feel like a replacement for two years ago," starting point guard Alicia Newbury said. "It would have been nice to get two of them."

One will have to do.

It was the most lopsided margin ever in a championship game.

The victory was sweet redemption for the Bulldogs.

Elida (26-1), ranked 11th in the final regular-season Associated Press poll, had also lost in the 1990 title game.

"I think each group is different," coach Vicki Mauk said. "Those teams worked hard to be here, just as this one did. The '95

team beat Trinity on Friday and had to come back in the finals on Saturday. I think we were mentally exhausted."

Vincent Warren shocked seventh-ranked Beloit West Branch, 58-56, in the semifinals and coach Dennis Biddinger said his team had a similar letdown against Elida.

"Our community was so proud they all wanted to congratulate them," he said. "When we finally had a team meeting at 9:30 last night, I told the kids that this was what this was all about — we still had a game to play. It was hard to get 15-, 16- and 17-year-olds to concentrate on a game after half of Washington County was parad-

ing through the hotel last night and telling them how proud they were."

Kalida 42, Fort Loramie 38 — Francine Miller never hit a bigger 3-pointer than with 12 seconds left to give Kalida a victory over Fort Loramie and the Division IV state championship.

The shot by Miller, a second-team All-Ohioan, gave the Wildcats their third state title in as many trips to the final four. They also won championships in 1988 and 1989.

The victory ran Kalida's record in final-four games to a spotless 6-0, the best among teams that has played that many games at the state tournament.

BY THE NUMBERS

BOYS BASKETBALL

Division I Regional Championships

Canton Civic Center

Cleveland Hts.	18	38	52	73
Firststone	13	29	46	64

Cleveland Hts.	Hams 27, Johnson 5, Dixon 18, Reed 14, Bremer 9
Firststone	Bel 5, J. Johnson 14, Justin Levy 10, Julian Levy 11, Leonard 6, Williams 16, M. Johnson 2

University of Toledo

Valley Forge	10	13	29	38
St. Edward	16	26	37	63

Valley Forge	Gest 2, Patton 12, Fontana 8, Collins 11, Hoffman 1, Williams 1, Tal 3
St. Edward	Holmes 2, Logan 25, Bartolone 15, Clancy 12, Lepore 2, Laikovic 1, McGraw 4, Myles 2

University of Toledo

Division II Regional Championships

University of Akron

Youngstown Mooney	19	33	47	60
Buchtel	15	33	54	64

Youngstown Mooney	Heilman 13, Venrose 18, Allegretto 13, Kurl 10, Bushey 4, Kompe 2
Buchtel	Sims 14, Robinson 12, Walker 12, D. Scott 10, Harvey 4, B. Davis 2, Hollis 6, W. Scott 2, M. Davis 2

University of Toledo

Benedictine	13	26	37	64
Olmsted Falls	16	29	45	57

Benedictine	Brown 25, Lanza 5, Back 16, Crosby 3, Wilson 11, Mandich 4
Olmsted Falls	Storey 9, Pellerite 9, Radigan 11, Kalamita 2, Schaefer 23, Williams 3

University of Toledo

Division III Regional Championships

Canton Fieldhouse

Youngstown Liberty	12	25	42	57
Villa Angela-St. Joseph	14	31	45	58

Youngstown Liberty	Campbell 1, Silverman 8, Austin 16, Mills 12, Harrison 9, Thomas 11
Villa Angela-St. Joseph	Pecjak 11, Riffe 5, Mette 2, Thomas 14, Perse 12, Smith 10, Kortovich 2, Barko 2

University of Toledo

ACROSS OHIO

DIVISION I REGIONAL CHAMPIONSHIPS

Springfield North 55 Cincinnati Aiken 52

Zanesville 71 Dayton Dunbar 61

DIVISION II REGIONAL CHAMPIONSHIPS

Columbus Millin 54 Hillsboro 45

Hamilton Badin 53 Cincinnati Roger Bacon 52

DIVISION III REGIONAL CHAMPIONSHIPS

Bellevue 58 Shenandoah 41

Dayton Christian 54 Cincinnati Wyoming 53

Patrick Henry 45 Ontario 43

DIVISION IV REGIONAL CHAMPIONSHIPS

Canton Civic Center

Cleveland Hts. 73 Firststone 64

University of Toledo

St. Edward 63 Valley Forge 38

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Division II State Championship

Vincent Warren	9	16	37	33
Elida	17	36	52	70

Vincent Warren	Wagner 7-23 1-1 15, J. Huck 2-3 0-0
Elida	Spence 0-1 1-2 1, J. Morris 0-3 0-0 0, Alloway 0-4 0-0

Vincent Warren	0-7 0-1 0, Nolan 0-8 0-1 0, Ohmer 5-13 3-4
Elida	5-12 0-1 0-0 0, A. Clark 0-0 0-0 0, D. Clark 0-0 0-0

Vincent Warren	0-0 0-0 0, L. Huck 0-2 0-0 0, Totals 14-55 5-9 33
Elida	Phillips 8-14 7 10 23, Croft 4-9 2-2 10, Stewart

Vincent Warren	2-4 2-6, Newbury 1-4 0-2, Heaphy 5-9 0-0 11, Olson
Elida	5-12 1-2 11, Miller 0-1 0-0, Holmes 0-0 3-4 3, Doy 1-1

Vincent Warren	0-0 2, Kantz 1-2 0-0 2, Boeke 0-0 0-0 0, Vargo 0-1 0-0
Elida	Totals 27-57 15-20 70

Vincent Warren	0-14 (E. Morris 0-1, Wag-
Elida	ner 0-2, J. Morris 0-3, L. Morris 0-3, Ohmer 0-5), Elida 1-6

Vincent Warren	(Heaphy 1-1, Newbury 0-1, Phillips 0-2, Olson 0-2), Re-
Elida	bounds—Vincent Warren 36 (J. Huck 7), Elida 47 (Phillips

Vincent Warren	11), Assists—Vincent Warren 6 (J. Huck 3), Elida 14 (Olson
Elida	5) Total fouls—Vincent Warren 18, Elida 15, A—7,077.

Division III State Championship

Chagrin Falls	14	20	33	49
Wauseon	16	41	58	71

Chagrin Falls	Wocholtz 3-7 0-1 6, Carson 4-17 8-12
Wauseon	Haase 3-6 0-1 6, K. Kruse 3-13 1-2 8, K. Kruse 1-5 8-11

Chagrin Falls	Miller 0-2 0-0 0, Korman 0-0 0-0 0, Cornell 1-1 0-2
Wauseon	Scott 0-2 0-0 0, Hiestermann 0-0 0-0 0, Givney 0-0 0-0 0

Chagrin Falls	Anderson 0-0 0-0 0, Totals 15-53 17-30 49
Wauseon	Ginggs 8-13 0-0 21, Burger 3-9 1-2 7, Roth

Chagrin Falls	0-2 0-0 0, Wood 0-1 0-0 0, Nease 0-1 0-0 0, Schreyer
Wauseon	1-3 4-5 6, Bostelman 0-4 3-4 3, Sanders 2-2 0-0 5, Stritz

Chagrin Falls	0-2 0-0 0, Weber 0-0 0-0 0, Dreher 0-0
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